

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-09-19

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 11:20-47

20 Abishai the brother of Joab was chief of another three. He had lifted up his spear against three hundred men, killed them, and won a name among these three.

21 Of the three he was more honored than the other two men. Therefore he became their captain. However he did not attain to the first three.

22 Benaiah was the son of Jehoiada, the son of a valiant man from Kabzeel, who had done many deeds. He had killed two lion-like heroes of Moab. He also had gone down and killed a lion in the midst of a pit on a snowy day.

23 And he killed an Egyptian, a man of great height, five cubits tall. In the Egyptian's hand there was a spear like a weaver's beam; and he went down to him with a staff, wrested the spear out of the Egyptian's hand, and killed him with his own spear.

24 These things Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did, and won a name among three mighty men.

25 Indeed he was more honored than the thirty, but he did not attain to the first three. And David appointed him over his guard.

26 Also the mighty warriors were Asahel the brother of Joab, Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,

27 Shammoth the Harorite, Helez the Pelonite,

28 Ira the son of Ikesh the Tekoite, Abiezer the Anathothite,

29 Sibbechai the Hushathite, Ilai the Ahohite,

30 Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the son of Baanah the Netophathite,

31 Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah, of the sons of Benjamin, Benaiah the Pirathonite,

32 Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel the Arbathite,

33 Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba the Shaalbonite,
34 the sons of Hashem the Gizonite, Jonathan the son of Shageh the Hararite,
35 Ahiam the son of Sacar the Hararite, Eliphal the son of Ur,
36 Hephher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the Pelonite,
37 Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son of Ezbai,
38 Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar the son of Hagri,
39 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the Berothite (the armorbearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah),
40 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,
41 Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of Ahlai,
42 Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite (a chief of the Reubenites) and thirty with him,
43 Hanan the son of Maachah, Joshaphat the Mithnite,
44 Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and Jeiel the sons of Hotham the Aroerite,
45 Jediahel the son of Shimri, and Joha his brother, the Tizite,
46 Eliel the Mahavite, Jeribai and Joshaviah the sons of Elnaam, Ithmah the Moabite,
47 Eliel, Obed, and Jaasiel the Mezobaite.

II. Key Summary

- Abishai lifted up his spear against three hundred men and killed them, won a name among the three and became their captain, though he did not attain to the first three.
 - Benaiah killed two lion-like heroes of Moab, went down and killed a lion in a pit on a snowy day, and wrested an Egyptian's spear from his hand and killed him with it; David appointed him over his guard.
 - Verses 26-47 list the mighty warriors name by name, including Naharai the armorbearer of Joab, Zelek the Ammonite, Uriah the Hittite, and Ithmah the Moabite.
-

III. Passage Analysis

Someone was standing beside them in all of this

How could one slay 300 and another the same number, another two lion-like men, and another an Egyptian giant, if they had not had the extraordinary presence of God with them, according to that promise, Jos. 23:10, One man of you shall chase a thousand, for the Lord your God fighteth for you? [1]

The passage gives us very concrete numbers for Abishai and Benaiah: three hundred men, one lion, an Egyptian five cubits tall. But what those numbers are pointing to is God standing beside them, not how strong they were on their own.

Every name on the list counts

Among these mighty men of David's kingdom there were men from the twelve tribes and also Levites; there were Israelites and also foreigners; there were men who "killed three hundred at one time" and also a man who "bore the armor." Their abilities and their backgrounds were different, yet the Spirit counted them all the same. [2]

From verse 26 on it is just a long run of names, easy to skim past. Yet Scripture writes in even Naharai, "the armorbearer of Joab the son of Zeruiah," and notes exactly what he did; an Ammonite and a Moabite are on the list too.

IV. Reflection Question

Today's passage is a list of names. Some killed three hundred men; one "bore the armor for Joab." What is something you did recently that nobody saw and nobody mentioned?

Scripture put that armorbearer on the list and spelled out exactly what he was doing — with God, nothing gets left off.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry, Complete Commentary on 1 Chronicles 11, https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_011.cfm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), 1 Chronicles 11 Gleanings, "1 Chronicles Comprehensive Bible Interpretation" (translated from Chinese),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT11.htm>